



PRESS RELEASE

REQUEST FOR EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI) FOR THE PROVISION OF PUBLIC BUS SERVICES IN BRUNEI DARUSSALAM

Wednesday 22nd June 2016 corresponding to 16th Ramadhan 1437 –

The Ministry of Communications, through the Land Transport Department, is currently embarking on initiatives to create a public transport system that is regulated, efficient, reliable, well connected, “People-Centric”, safe and sustainable. This project is targeted to be implemented by the 3rd Quarter of this year for taxis and by mid-2017 for buses.

The whole project involves the Ministry of Communications reviewing its policies on the provision of public transport services in Brunei Darussalam and identifying the arising weaknesses of the current public transport system. Towards implementation of this project, the Ministry is therefore revamping existing systems and introducing significant initiatives that represent major milestones within the overall implementation plan prepared.

To improve the connectivity and accessibility of public buses, the Ministry of Communications, through the Land Transport Department (LTD), has revamped the nationwide bus route network from the existing 29 routes to 42 main bus routes which comprises 28 main bus routes in Brunei-Muara, 5 in the KB-Seria area, 2 in Tutong, 2 in the Temburong district and 5 Inter-district routes. To further increase connectivity and accessibility, 21 feeder bus services for residential areas will also be introduced.

One of the key components to the government-intervention-related approach is to ensure the best model(s) that suits Brunei current resources and scenario. During the formulation process, a few models have been reviewed and further analysis is still being carried out to secure the best one that will ensure efficiency and sustainability of the new public transport system.

To realize operations for these routings, an EOI (Expression of Interest) will therefore be released commencing Saturday, 25th June 2016. The objectives of this EOI is to identify a professional and competent public bus service provider(s) who can:

- i. Improve the level of service in order to meet the public's needs and increase bus patronage and ridership;
- ii. Optimize the efficiency and effectiveness of the bus route network, taking into account social considerations and improving mobility of the public;
- iii. Provide uninterrupted service by adhering to schedules or maintain regular headways and consistent travel times.
- iv. Provide high standard and comfort service by introducing new bus fleets that meet route network requirements.
- v. Utilize Intelligent Transport Systems to provide more effective operational control as well as reliable information for users and the authority;
- vi. Utilize bus ticketing systems that will provide the choice of off-bus ticketing and facilitate regular travel solutions to the public.

The EOI is opened to local companies / cooperatives or international organizations with vast experience in public transport services to provide bus services that are reliable and efficient for Brunei Darussalam. The closing date for this EOI is 26th July 2016.

Prior to this and as an initial move to improve the image of public transport in the country, the Ministry of Communications, through the Land Transport Department recently launched a public voting initiative on the top ten (10) colours and designs of public buses submitted by members of the public in May 2016 which are currently being voted on by members of the public. Voting will be opened for two (2) weeks commencing Monday 20th June 2016 until Sunday 3rd July 2016. This rebranding initiative therefore signifies a preliminary move to transform not only the image of the public transport system but to encompass proposed initiatives to ensure its reliability, connectivity and sustainability for all in the country.